

WHAT YOU RECEIVE

Negotiation Strategy Memo

A licensed NC GC reads the buyer's concession demands and tells you, per item, what's legitimate, what's inflated, and what a fair counter looks like — so you negotiate from construction reality instead of guessing.

PREPARED FOR

Sample · listing-side · Charlotte NC
\$299 · 1 business day · NC GC License #107724

HOW TO READ THIS MEMO

Their ask vs. reality

The buyer asked for \$24,000 in credits. This memo prices each item the way a GC would, flags what's inflated, and gives you a defensible counter — with talking points you can use on the client call.

THE BUYER'S ASK

\$24,000 total across 6 items, citing their inspection. Summarized and analyzed item-by-item on the next pages.

SAMPLE

THE VERDICT

Counter at ~\$9,500

\$24K ASK → \$9,500 FAIR

Three items are legitimate, two are inflated, one is normal wear. Counter basis below.

THE HEADLINE

The buyer stacked a real HVAC concern with three cosmetic/maintenance items dressed up as defects. Concede the legitimate ones, document why the rest aren't, and you've cut the ask by 60% with a GC standing behind your number.

SAMPLE

PER-ISSUE ANALYSIS

Legit, inflated, or normal wear

BUYER ASK	AMOUNT	VERDICT	FAIR
HVAC replacement	\$10,000	Legit (18 yrs)	\$6,000
'Failing' roof	\$8,000	Inflated (8 yrs left)	\$0
Plumbing leak	\$2,500	Legit	\$2,500
Panel issues	\$2,000	Legit	\$1,000
'Old' water heater	\$1,000	Normal wear	\$0
Cosmetic cracks	\$500	Normal wear	\$0

COUNTER-RANGE

Where to land

RECOMMENDED COUNTER: \$9,500

Open at \$8,500 (the three legitimate items at GC cost), settle up to \$9,500. Anything above \$10K means you're paying for the inflated roof and the normal-wear items — don't.

WALK-AWAY READ

This buyer wants the house — the inflated asks are a test, not a dealbreaker. A documented, GC-backed counter holds; they're unlikely to walk over a roof that has 8 years of life.

SAMPLE

TALKING POINTS

For the client call

WHAT TO TELL YOUR SELLER

"A licensed GC reviewed their list. Three items are real and we should credit them — about \$9,500. The roof has 8 years left and the inspector confirmed it; the water heater and cracks are normal wear. We'll counter at \$9,500 with the GC's itemized basis attached, so it's their inflated number vs. our documented one."

SAMPLE

INFLATION PATTERNS

How asks get padded

PATTERN	WHAT TO WATCH FOR
Replace what can be repaired	'Failing roof' with 8 yrs of life = repair, not replace
Retail-price the labor	Quoting full retail on items a GC sources at trade cost
Normal wear as defect	Aged-but-working water heater billed as a credit item
Stack cosmetics	Hairline cracks + caulk lines padded onto a real concern

THE TELL

A legitimate ask is specific and proportional. When the total is round, the items are vague, and the cosmetics are stacked on a single real issue, you're looking at a negotiating position — not a repair bill.

WHY THIS WORKS

Construction reality beats vibes

THE EDGE

Most concession fights are won by whoever has documentation. The buyer has an inspection that says 'noted'; you have a licensed GC who says 'here's what it actually costs.' That asymmetry is the whole product.

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SAMPLE